

Florence (Flori) So

CONTACT INFORMATION

Department of Political Science, the University of Gothenburg
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EMPLOYMENT

Associate Professor Department of Political Science, the University of Gothenburg	07/2025- present
Researcher Department of Political Science, Lund University	09/2024 - 06/2025
Sick leave	02/2025 - 06/2025
Marie Curie Fellow Department of Political Science, Lund University	11/2021 - 08/2024
Sick leave	06/2022 - 09/2023
Sick leave and maternity leave	11/2017 - 10/2021
Assistant Professor Department of Political Science, Aarhus University, Denmark	01/2013-06/2018

EFFECTIVE NUMBER OF YEARS SINCE PH.D.

8 years and 2 months (as of September 2026)

EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Political Science, University of California, Los Angeles <i>Subfield Concentration:</i> Formal Theory and Quantitative Methods, Comparative Politics <i>Dissertation Project:</i> “Party Leadership Selection in Parliamentary Democracies” <i>Dissertation Committee:</i> Kathleen Bawn (Chair), Jeffrey Lewis, Michael Thies, and James Adams (UC Davis)	2005-2012
M.A. in International Relations, University of San Diego	2003-2004
B.S. in Biochemistry; Interdisciplinary Studies (Double Major), Calvin College	2000-2003

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Coalition politics; consequences of gender bias; political consequences of the macroeconomic condition; political economy of elections; parties and elections; and game theory.

PAPERS IN PEER-REVIEWED JOURNALS

2026. “The Impacts of Scandal-Based Coalition Terminations on Voters” (with Ida B. Hjerimitslev), *European Journal of Political Research* 1-25. doi:10.1017/S1475676526101194.
2024. “Serious Conflicts with Benign Outcomes? The Electoral Consequences of Conflictual Cabinet Dissolutions.” *The American Political Science Review* 118 (3): 1449-1463.
2021. “Don’t Air Your Dirty Laundry: Party Leadership Contests, Policy Competence, and Parliamentary Election Outcomes.” *The European Journal of Political Research* 60 (1): 3-24.
2018. “More Spotlight, More Problems? Westminster Parliamentary Systems and Leadership Replacement in Large Opposition Parties.” *Party Politics* 24 (5): 588-597.
2018. “Attract Voters or Appease Grassroots? Opposition Party Leaders’ Dilemma and Positional Shift.” *Journal of Theoretical Politics* 30 (2): 246-266.
2018. “One Size Doesn’t Fit All: Voter Decision Criteria Heterogeneity and Vote Choice.” (with Henrik Seeberg and Rune Stubager) *Electoral Studies* 52: 1-10.
2018. “The Agenda Setting Power of the Prime Minister Party in Coalition Governments.” (with Christoffer Green-Pedersen and Peter B. Mortensen) *Political Research Quarterly* 71 (4): 473-456.

PAPERS UNDER REVIEW

- “Keep Calm and Carry On: Democratic Parliamentary Monarchs and Citizens’ Satisfaction with Democracy” (with Andrej Kokkonen)

WORKING PAPERS

- “Women Ministers and Cabinet Terminations”
- “Do Women Politicians Hold more Liberal Democratic Attitudes? The Case of Swedish MPs”
- “Get TAN-ed when the Economy Goes South? Economic Downturn, TAN Issues, and the Electoral Performances of Prime Ministers’ Parties”
- “Do Partisans Jump Ship? The Macroeconomy’s Impact on Opposition Parties”

GRANTS

- “More Money, Different Problems? Peoples’ Engagement with Politics during Good Economic Times (ECONENGAGE)”
Principal Investigator, 2025 ERC Starting Grant, The European Commission
Award amount: 1,979,490 EUR 2026-2031
- “The Coalition Life Cycle and Democracy.”
Co-Investigator, FRONTIER Seed Grant, Aalborg University (PI: Ida B. Hjerimitslev)
Award amount: 100,000 DKK 2026
- “Mass-Elite Politics in Established Democracies”
Principal Investigator, Riksbanken Jubileumsfond Research Initiation Grant, Sweden
Award amount: 284,107 SEK 2025

“Political Economy and Behavior.”

Principal Investigator, Riksbanken Jubileumsfond Research Initiation Grant, Sweden

Award amount: 319,314 SEK

2024

“Divided Parliaments? Polarization, Moralization, and the Risk of Gridlock.”

Co-Investigator, Riksbanken Jubileumsfond Project Grant, Sweden (PI: Hanna Bäck

Award amount: 6,273,643 SEK

2024-2026

“Gender Dynamics in Politics, the Workplace, and Society.”

Principal Investigator, Riksbanken Jubileumsfond Research Initiation Grant, Sweden

Award amount: 217,057 SEK

2023

“The Impacts of Economic Growth and Decline on Party Behavior.”

Principal Investigator, Marie Curie Individual Fellowship, The European Commission

Award amount: 203,850 EUR

2021-2023

“Electoral Institutions and Political Divisiveness in Established Democracies.”

Principal Investigator, Carlsberg Foundation Postdoctoral Grant, Denmark

Award amount: 123,148 EUR

2016-2018

FELLOWSHIPS

AxPo Visiting Fellow, Sciences Po

May-June 2024

UCLA Departmental Fellowship

2011-2012

Stokes Dissertation Research Fellowship, The British Politics Group

2011

Dissertation Research Fellowship, UCLA Center for European and Eurasian Studies

2011

EITM, National Science Foundation

2009 and 2010

Academic Year Graduate Research Mentorship Fellowship, UCLA

2006-2007

Summer Graduate Research Mentorship Fellowship, UCLA

2006

UCLA Fellowship, UCLA

2005-2010

INVITED TALKS AND WORKSHOPS

- Monday Seminar Series, Department of Government, the University of Vienna, November 2026 (expected)
- Comparative Politics Seminar, Stockholm University, October 2026 (expected)
- POLSEK Seminar Series, Uppsala University, January 2026
- HPS Seminar Series, the University of Hamburg, April 2025
- Politics and Society Seminar Series, Aalborg University, October 2024
- AxPo-CEE Joint Seminar, Sciences Po Paris, May 2024
- MZES Colloquium, University of Mannheim, November 2023
- Party Politics Seminar Series, Gothenburg University, February 2023
- Workshop on Party Politics, Aarhus University, November 2022
- Workshop on Coalition and Party Politics, Lund University, September 2022
- Workshop on Intra- and Inter-party conflicts, Humboldt University in Berlin, August 2022

- Comparative Politics Lunch Seminar, Lund University, May 2019
- Workshop on Party Leaders, Södertörn University, Stockholm, November 2017
- Workshop on Intra-Party Politics, University of Gothenburg, September 2015
- Political Economy Research Seminar, University of Mannheim, September 2013
- Political Economy Series, Lund University, September 2013.
- High Seminar in Political Science, Södertörn University. September 2011.

CONFERENCE PARTICIPATION

- American Political Science Association Annual Conference: 2010, 2013, 2015, 2017, 2025
- European Political Science Association Annual Conference: 2012, 2014, 2016, 2023, 2024
- Midwest Political Science Association Annual Conference: 2008-2016
- Southern Political Science Association Annual Conference: 2012
- European Consortium of Political Research General Conference: 2014
- Comparative Agendas Project Annual Conference: 2013-2016
- Council of European Studies Annual Conference: 2015, 2017

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

“Applied Statistical Analyses ” (master’s seminar, co-taught with Mattias Agerberg, Rasmus Broms, and Maria Solevid)	Fall 2025
“Comparative Politics: Actors and Institutions” (master’s seminar, co-taught with Hanna Bäck, Agustín Goenaga, Robert Klemmensen, and Jonathan Polk)	Spring 2024, 2023
“Parties and Political Behavior” (bachelor’s seminar course coordinator, co-taught with Esther Calvo)	Autumn 2023, 2022
Instructor for Course in Game Theory	2016 ECPR Methods Winter School
“Explaining Politics through Game Theory: Strategies, Collective Action, and Paradoxes in the Modern World” (master’s seminar in game theory)	Spring 2017, Autumn 2015, 2014, 2013
“Game Theory and International Security” (master’s seminar, co-taught with Bruno Oliveira Martins)	Spring 2015
“Strategies in Political Violence and Conflict” (master’s seminar, co-taught with Jakob Tolstrup in Danish)	Autumn 2014
“Social Science Research Methods for Journalism” (Erasmus Mundus seminar, co-taught with Morten Brænder and Lasse Nielsen)	Spring 2015, 2014

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Co-convener, Comparative Politics Seminar Series, Lund University (Jan - Dec 2023)

Referee for the *American Journal of Political Science*, *Electoral Studies*, the *European Journal of Political Research*, *European Political Science Review*, the *Journal of Politics*, *Legislative Studies Quarterly*, and *Representation*

Grant reviewer (Czech Social Science Foundation; Velux Foundation)

PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITIES

Workshop organizer, “Mass-Elite Politics in Established Democracies.” June 2026

Workshop organizer, “Political Economy and Behavior.” September 2024

Workshop organizer, “Gender Dynamics in Politics, the Workplace, and Society.” September 2023

Workshop organizer, “Democratic Representation in Established Democracies.” November 2017

Section co-chair, 2014 European Consortium of Political Science (ECPR) Conference, Glasgow, Scotland

Panel organizer, 2014 and 2013 Midwest Political Science Association Conferences, Chicago, IL

Panel organizer, 2013 American Political Science Association Conference, Chicago, IL

LANGUAGES

English (native), Chinese: Mandarin and Cantonese (fluent), Danish (fluent), French (fluent), Burmese (speaking, fluent), Swedish (intermediate)

REFERENCES

Available upon requests